

nect wirelessly using Bluetooth connectivity.

Of the three, the Garmin Mobile 10 was the best looking of the lot but the Satguide GPS Bluetooth Receiver was slightly more compact. There really isn't a big difference in functionality between these two devices. They both have a simple on/off switch which turns on the device. All you really need to do is turn on the Bluetooth on your laptop or phone, scan for Bluetooth devices and then add the GPS unit. You can then choose to use any software and the maps for it on your phone.

We used the devices with a laptop and a Windows Mobile without any problems. Setting up was pretty straight forward and with the serial link via Bluetooth set up, we were able to use the receivers along with some of the software for Windows Mobile.

The price for the Garmin Mobile 10 is Rs 11,025 and Rs 4,290 for the Satguide GPS Bluetooth Receiver. The Garmin Mobile 10 is a lot more expensive but the price tag isn't totally justified. It comes with software for the desktop and the Windows Mobile platform - nRoute and Garmin Mobile XT.

For those who want something a little different - something that can monitor your tracks for you, there is a device by Satguide called the GPS Logger which we reviewed a few months back. This device too has the same Bluetooth functionality as the GPS Receiver from Satguide but it does the additional task of storing data on the memory. Once you've completed your trip, you can attach it to a computer and download all the data which can be used on software such as Google Earth with the least bit

of effort. This is useful where you want to monitor the routes through which your vehicles travel by. The Satguide GPS Logger is priced at Rs 6,990 which is a fairly good price and it removes the need for a separate device of either a phone or computer to store data on it.

Conclusion

We've been pleasantly surprised to see the number of GPS systems available and the number steadily growing for the consumer market. We were impressed by the details on the maps. Getting this amount of data collected, sorted and put into maps has required an enormous amount of effort. Work is still on and updates are still regularly available to improve maps by all of the brands.

Now coming to what we think of the products, we like the Garmin Nuvi 350 the most for its very elegant design and feel. The new MapmyIndia 430 Classic is larger than the rest but has a stylish and modern look to it. The maps on it were equally detailed as well. If you have the choice between the two, we'd recommend you go for the Nuvi 350 but the MapmyIndia 430 Classic would be the best if there was a budget constraint. The Satguide Mio C230 is the cheapest of the lot but we aren't so fond of their interface. For all practical uses and for those who just want a GPS system for their car for as cheap as possible, that is the way to go. Among the Bluetooth receivers, we like the Satguide GPS Receiver mainly for its price. As for those want to log data of your travel routes, the Satguide GPS Logger is the only option you have. It's a bit more expensive than the receiver but it's well worth the price.



Satguide GPS Receiver

We like the idea of Bluetooth receivers as they give the user the flexibility and choice of the maps and the software that you use. Phones with Bluetooth connectivity are something that everybody has these days. Our only concern is that mobile phones drain down their battery too quickly with Bluetooth left on. In most phones, it's possible to drain the battery within five hours of using it. This still is a great way to experience how to use a GPS.

Windows Mobile is also the preferred platform and there are plenty of commercial and free open source software being developed for it on communities on the Internet. There are applications for Symbian as well but Windows Mobile seems to be the more preferred one for GPS. Google Earth Plus is one of simplest software for those who want to use it with their laptops while sitting in a car or travelling by a long distance train.

The whole idea of being to track where you go and then revisit it online or show others the way to reach places is great.. We like the idea of using GPS units for everyday use and will definitely be looking at more GPS systems in the future. ■

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